



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cameroon: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 30 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-14 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Cabinet reviewed the national artificial-intelligence strategy on 30 July and was told it is [still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) — a year after a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars was presented. The same session recorded Cameroon as a [founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#), with no accession date published.

Payments moved regionally rather than nationally: an [interoperable QR-code standard launched at Douala on 29 July](#), and the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system on 9 July](#).

The data-protection authority's position was restated and did not change: [created in law, not established, and carrying no appropriation in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

An account of 27 July put the national fibre backbone at [over 15,000 km](#), against about 12,000 km terrestrial on the 2024 reference year; the two figures are not reconciled to a single primary and may rest on different measurement bases.

The same account records the [2024 customs circular on satellite terminals still operative](#), with kits entering through indirect registration abroad and ten modems seized at one post in December 2025.

Cybersecurity

A [fourth loan tranche of FCFA 39.2bn for intelligent urban video surveillance was authorised by decree](#), bringing FCFA 150.8bn mobilised over eight years across three Chinese lenders. The first phase's borrower was the defence ministry, and the two accounts held give different amounts and dates for it. No camera count, coverage area, retention rule or oversight arrangement is published for any tranche.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

On 29 July a joint communiqué [established a trilateral customs steering committee with Nigeria and Benin](#), committing to harmonised procedures, digital interoperability and coordinated risk management on two named corridors, with no timeline, budget or system specification published.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Two identity operations ran in the month, both municipal. On 27 July [4,000 free identity cards were handed over at Yaoundé 5](#), some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site; the operation was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. From 3 July, [compulsory registration of taxi owners and drivers opened on a city platform](#), with a QR code and a unique door number per driver and unregistered taxis barred after 5 October.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Payments had the month's densest run. On 9 July the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system, extending it to all six member states and 72m people](#), with member-state banks to be integrated by end-2026; no Cameroonian bank is yet named as live on it. On 29 July an [interoperable QR-code standard launched under a regional regulation of 8 April](#), letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six states. A day later a [consultation opened on revising the switch's tariff grid](#), the operator conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments; no revised grid or effective date is published.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

The [national civil-status registry platform was reported deployed in pilot councils on 16 July](#); the source names no councils and gives no target.

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

Health and education information systems both gained instruments and neither reports a deliverable. A [EUR 8m technical-assistance agreement over 36 months covers the education management information system, the basic-education ministry's mapping platform, interconnection of the education databases and dynamic dashboards](#); the funder is not stated and the signature date is not published. The [national digital health strategic plan launched on 4 March with an envelope of about FCFA 29bn across eight axes including governance, legal framework and health-information-system interoperability](#), and a [pandemic preparedness project was launched](#) with no deliverable reported.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The same seminar put council digitisation at [230 councils, about 64% nationally, with 48.6% of North West councils operating functional websites, 335 municipal portals developed and 145 authorities equipped](#).

National statistics

The fourth population and agriculture census is still in the field: a [complementary enumeration period runs from 1 August to 15 September to reach households, persons and agricultural holdings missed by the 29 May close](#). Enumeration ran with [32,059 agents at a budget of FCFA 13.28bn against FCFA 64bn initially projected](#), and no results are published. It is the first census in over twenty years, with population and agriculture merged into one questionnaire.

Governance and regulation

Strategies, plans and policies

An account of 27 July set out where the satellite licence stands: a [draft concession convention and specification finalised by the regulator, the file at the ministry undecided for more than two years, and the 2024 seizure circular still operative](#). The objections on record are lawful interception, armed-group use, and the incumbent's commercial position.

Open data

A national open-data policy is [provided for in the artificial-intelligence roadmap and nothing is published](#). It was [not among the ten priority areas tabled to cabinet on 30 July](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

Cabinet was told on 30 July that the [national AI strategy is still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) and no adoption instrument published; a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars had been presented in July 2025. The [AI authority and presidential council that roadmap provided for remain uncreated](#) and are absent from the ten priorities, which carry only adaptation of the legal framework. Among the priorities is a [national high-performance computing centre](#), announced with no site, cost, operator or timetable. At the same session the telecommunications minister said Cameroon had [acceded as a founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#); the accession date is not published.

US / hyperscaler activities

On 8 July the state operator held a [working session with a global cloud vendor's Africa executives and the United States embassy ICT representative](#). It is [talks only: no agreement, investment commitment, timeline, or answer on where Cameroonian data would sit](#), and it sits against the operator's own sovereign-cloud line and a regional data-residency recommendation.

Inclusion and capacity

Literacy

A digital financial-literacy project running in Cameroon and Senegal since June 2024 [closed on 15 July](#), leaving a digital financial-services comparison platform with no funded data-update mechanism; it was offered to both states and neither is reported as having accepted. No Cameroon-side trainee count, budget share or partner list is published.

Training and skills

The AI workforce target was carried into the same cabinet review without moving: [60,000 specialists by 2040 including 40% women](#) was set in July 2025, and a year later [AI modules in curricula appear among ten priorities with a roadmap tabled but no adoption, budget line or trainee count](#).

What was delivered was smaller and dated. A first implementation wave under an operator and higher-education memorandum [opened 115 internships across all ten regions on 22 July](#), in disciplines from telecommunications and cybersecurity to finance and law; no stipend, duration or conversion-to-employment figure is published.

Research institutions

Two research builds were tabled in the same cabinet review list — a [sovereign scientific database on a dedicated national platform](#) and a [centre for the digitisation of scientific and technical information](#) — with no cost, site or timeline for either.

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